XYLOMETAZOLINE

Max 5–7 days (rebound)

Fast relief

CHEMICAL NAME 2-(4-tert-butyl-2,6-dimethylbenzyl)-4,5-dihydro-1H-imidazole (hydrochloride)

CLASS Topical α-adrenergic nasal decongestant (imidazoline)

TRADE NAMES Otrivin · Otrivine · Xylo-Mepha · Olynth

THERAPEUTIC USES / INDICATIONS

- Nasal congestion: common cold, sinusitis, allergic rhinitis (short-term).
- To aid drainage in sinusitis and otitis media.
- Before nasal procedures (mucosal vasoconstriction).

ADMINISTRATION

- **Nasal spray or drops:** blow nose first, tilt head slightly forward, spray into each nostril, breathe in gently.
- Clean tip after use; one bottle per person.
- Use 0.05% (paediatric) strength for children.

DOSAGES

- **Adult & ≥12 yr (0.1%):** 1 spray/2–3 drops each nostril 2–3 times daily.
- **Children 6–11 yr (0.05%):** 1–2 drops each nostril 1–2 times daily.
- Max 5–7 days continuous use; not under 6 yr (OTC).

PHARMACOKINETICS

- **Onset:** 5–10 min. **Duration:** 8–12 h.
- Minimal systemic absorption at normal doses.

PHARMACODYNAMICS

- Stimulates **α1/α2 receptors** on nasal blood vessels → vasoconstriction → ↓ mucosal swelling and congestion.

SIDE & ADVERSE EFFECTS

SIDE EFFECTS (COMMON)

- Nasal burning, stinging, dryness, sneezing.
- Headache.
- Nosebleeds.

ADVERSE EFFECTS (SERIOUS)

- Rebound congestion (rhinitis medicamentosa) with prolonged use.
- Systemic absorption in infants: bradycardia, sedation, coma.
- Hypertension, palpitations (excess use).

CONTRAINDICATIONS & CAUTIONS

- Children <6 yr (OTC); infants (toxicity).
- After trans-sphenoidal surgery; narrow-angle glaucoma.
- Rhinitis sicca; MAOI use; **caution** in hypertension, heart disease.

KEY INTERACTIONS

- **MAOIs, TCAs:** hypertensive reactions.
- Other sympathomimetics.

NURSING MANAGEMENT

- Teach correct technique and duration limit.
- Assess for overuse and rebound congestion.
- Use saline drops for infants instead.

PATIENT EDUCATION

- Use for no more than 5–7 days; longer use makes congestion worse.
- Do not share the bottle.
- Blow nose before use.

KEY POINTS

- Topical α-agonist decongestant.
- Fast onset, lasts 8–12 h.
- Max 5–7 days; rebound congestion.
- Avoid in young children.